



PRACTICAL TEST AUTOMATION WITH PLAYWRIGHT

# Cross-Browser & Mobile Testing Guide

Run your tests across browsers and device viewports with confidence.

## Introduction

Real users are on different browsers and devices. Playwright makes cross-browser and mobile-viewport testing straightforward through projects. This guide shows you how to use it sensibly.

## Projects for Browsers

- Define projects for chromium, firefox and webkit in the config.
- The same tests run across all configured projects.
- Run one with: `npx playwright test --project=firefox`

## Mobile Viewports

Use device descriptors (e.g. `devices['iPhone 13']`) in a project to emulate viewport, user agent and touch — useful for catching responsive layout issues.

## Worked Example (config projects)

- `{ name: 'chromium', use: devices['Desktop Chrome'] }`
- `{ name: 'webkit', use: devices['Desktop Safari'] }`
- `{ name: 'mobile', use: devices['iPhone 13'] }`

## Choosing Scope

| Run             | When                         |
|-----------------|------------------------------|
| One browser     | Fast local development       |
| All browsers    | CI / before release          |
| Mobile viewport | Responsive/critical journeys |

## Practical Exercise

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Add a mobile project to your config and run a key journey on it. Note any layout differences from desktop.

## Best Practices

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- Develop on one browser; verify on all in CI.
- Focus mobile runs on critical journeys.
- Use device descriptors rather than hand-setting viewports.

## Common Mistakes

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- Running the full matrix locally and slowing yourself down.
- Emulation differences mistaken for real device bugs.
- Ignoring mobile entirely.

### INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Emulation is great for layout and logic, but it is not a real device. For business-critical mobile flows, confirm key findings on a real device before sign-off.